Title-chain authenticity audit — Great House Farm / Tŷ Mawr alias Cedfin, Llandough-juxta-Penarth

25 Oct 2026. Key: **yes** = we hold or have read the record itself; **recital only** = known from a mention of it (register entry, later deed, judgment, press or archive catalogue); **no** = nothing seen. J = BP Properties Ltd v Buckler [1987] EWCA Civ 2. EV = family evidence register. Compulsory registration here began 1 Dec 1975; any earlier registration would have been voluntary.

Link	Date	Instrument seen?	Where held / source	How to obtain (free first)
OPPOSING PAPER CHAIN (Bute → Mountjoy → WGR → BP → registration)				
Bute owner of the farm before 1900 (Windsor inheritance; Llandough manor bought 1793)	pre-1900	**recital only** (catalogue)	Glamorgan Archives DB fonds history; corroborated by 1824 survey DB/E/1 (EV-0211, part held), tithe c.1841 (EV-0215)	DB/E/1 and tithe free online/in person; title deeds not traced
3rd Marquess will: Llandough parish to Lord Colum	30 Jul 1894 / 1900	**recital only** (press)	Press reports 1900 (F047, EV-0012); probate registry	Probate copy (small fee); press free (BNA snippets)
Bute → Cardiff Corporation: "rights" (sewer easement, inferred)	23 Feb 1905	**recital only** (register entry)	HMLR, copy filed under WA231076; WA735527 Charges 1	HMLR SAR reply (due 28 Oct, free) or official copy (fee)
Bute → John Williams: yearly tenancy "whole of the farm", with plan	Feb 1916	**recital only** (judgment)	J; EV-0014 (holder not located)	Family papers? Bute estate papers (DB)
Mountjoy Ltd formed; takes Lord Bute's "life interest" (minerals "turned over" 1922)	May 1922	**recital only** (press)	Press 12-13 May 1922; WM 11 Aug 1931 (BNA). No company file found (TNA BT 31: none)	Glamorgan Archives DB (free); Bute archive, Mount Stuart (private, ask)
"Remaining Bute property" incorporated in Mountjoy	1926	**recital only** (catalogue)	TNA GB 0214 DB/DA admin history (F043)	As above
Bute/Mountjoy → WGR: "Conveyance on sale"	25 Dec 1938 (compl. 23 Dec)	**recital only** (1965 contract cond. F; press)	EV-0216 (Vale FOI); F042; EV-0019 says "family-held per wiki" (no scan)	1) Family copy? 2) HMLR SAR (free) 3) Vale school-site deeds, EIR (free)
WGR mortgage back to Mountjoy; surrendered 1944	1938–1944	**recital only** (catalogue)	Glamorgan Archives D696/2	Free to view in person
WGR → John Williams: monthly letting of Parcel B "reserving quarrying rights"	18 May 1939	**part** (plan held; p.1 missing)	Glamorgan Archives DBDT123/7 (EV-0023)	Free to view in person; copy fee
Surrender of 1916 tenancy; regrant to Frederick	2 Feb 1949	**recital only** (judgment)	J (unwritten)	—
WGR / S.W. Brick & Tile / Cardiff Corp: rights over woodland strip	29 Mar 1961	**recital only** (register entry)	HMLR, copy under WA231076; WA735527 Charges 3 (EV-0040)	HMLR SAR (free) or official copy (fee)
WGR → British Petroleum Pension Trust (sale)	completed 31 Dec 1969	**no**	BP successors' deeds; HMLR 1982/83 application files	HMLR SAR (free); TNA BT 31/87651 (view free at Kew)
Conveyance leading to woodland first registration	19 Nov 1982	**recital only** (register)	HMLR WA231076 (appl. 30 Nov 1982)	HMLR SAR (free)
First registration of farm, BP Properties (Linklaters)	23 Feb 1983	**part** (register view, not official copy)	HMLR WA240304; form 1C, statutory declaration, D23 pending	HMLR SAR item 10–13 (free, due 28 Oct)
WILLIAMS / BUCKLER SIDE				
Family occupation "since 1667" (Mrs M. D. Buckler, reported)	1958 statement	**no** (reported speech, OCR)	Western Mail 20 Nov 1958 p7 (EV-0037)	BNA page image (subscription)
Bute leases of "Cydfin Farm or Ty Mawr Farm" (107 a.) — shows Bute as lessor	1552–1824	**recital only** (catalogue)	NLW Bute D219/1, 4–5, 8 (EV-0003)	NLW in person (free); pending NLW request
Tithe: occupier "Williams John"; landowner "Bute the Marquess of" (33) and glebe (3)	c.1841	**yes**	NLW tithe map/apportionment (EV-0215)	Free online
Poor-rate books: John Williams, "farm under Lord Bute"	1872–76	**yes** (provisional)	Glamorgan Archives (EV-0212)	Free in person
Reported lease to John Williams (a lease implies tenancy)	6 Nov 1877	**no** (original unlocated)	Wiki self-correction (DBDT 79/1 is a different lease)	Family papers? Glamorgan Archives search
Copyhold of Llandough manor (would have become freehold 1 Jan 1926)	to 1925	**no** (no record found)	Glamorgan Archives DB/M/1–9 court books 1877–1937 (unread)	Free to view in person: the key Williams-side test
1881 census "Llandough Home Farm", John Williams farmer	3 Apr 1881	**yes**	TNA RG11/5288 (EV-0224)	Free
1916 tenancy from Bute; 1939 letting from WGR; 1930s/40s arrears	1916–1949	**recital only** / part	J; EV-0014; EV-0023	As above
1928 last house-parcel rent receipt	1928	**no** (Mary's account)	EV-0016 (not located)	Family papers

Reading. Every operative instrument in the opposing chain from 1922 to 1983 is known only from recitals, press or catalogues. The Williams-side records we hold are of occupation and tenancy, and they name Bute as landowner (1824, c.1841, 1872–76, 1916, 1939). None shows a Williams freehold or copyhold title. Neither side's root is proven from a document in hand. What is genuinely open is whether Bute's title passed, via Mountjoy, to WGR for this land on 25 Dec 1938. That deed is the one to get. Ingredients for discussion; not a finding of any court; no wrongdoing by any person is stated.